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CHINESE COMMUNIST VIEWS ON THE STATUS OF FORMOSA

The present Chinese Communist claim that Formosa is traditional Chinese territory is of relatively recent origin, dating only from 1950, after they gained power and after the Nationalists took refuge on Formosa. Their traditional position, echoing the international Communist line and consistently expressed until as late as 1947, was that Formosa should be granted independence.

In 1932, the Executive Committee of the Communist International (COMINTERN) adopted a resolution which stated in part:

> "The Communists of Korea and Formosa, in close collaboration with the C.P. of Japan and the C.P. of China, must mobilize the workers and peasants of Korea and Formosa for the struggle against Japanese imperialism, for the independence of Korea and Formosa, and must establish a revolutionary alliance of the oppressed and exploited for the national liberation struggle." (Emphasis supplied.)

This view was also voiced by Mao Tse-tung to Edgar Snow on July 16, 1936, when he stated:

> "It is the immediate task of China to regain all our lost territories, not merely to defend our sovereignty below the Great Wall. This means that Manchuria must be regained. We do not, however, include Korea, formerly a Chinese colony, but when we have reestablished the independence of the lost territories of China, and if the Koreans wish to break away from the chains of Japanese militarism, we will extend them our enthusiastic help in their struggle for independence. The same thing applies to Formosa."[1] (Emphasis supplied.)

Two years before, in 1934, Wang Ming, a Chinese Communist delegate, reported to a meeting of the executive committee of the Comintern "the experience of our party [the Chinese Communist Party] in the development of the Soviet revolution in China has become an important factor and provides a significant lesson in the emancipation struggle of the peoples of Indochina, India, Korea, Formosa, and the whole colonial world."

In October 1940, the Communists announced the formation of the "Federation of Formosan Revolutionaries," composed of the "Formosan Independence Revolutionary Party," the "Formosan Revolutionary League," and other Formosan revolutionaries. The first issue of the Formosa Vanguard, official organ of this organization, carried a manifesto of the newly formed organization, which stated: "In

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1. Edgar Snow, Red Star Over China. Mao checked Snow's text before publication. A Russian edition of this book, which was extensively edited, contains this paragraph unchanged.

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"In China's final victory lies the hope for success of the Formosan Revolution, while the emancipation of Formosa from Japanese control is vitally important to China's national defense.

"If China wants to be permanently free from Japanese aggression, she has to build up her sea defense. This can be done along the Fukien and Kwangtung coast with Amoy, Kiungchow and Ponghu Lake /Pescadores anchorage/ of Formosa as a triangular base. The restoration of the freedom of Formosa, therefore, is strategically necessary to China."

Even after World War II the Chinese Communists held this same position. In March 1947, in commenting on the February-March incidents, involving uprisings of Formosans against the provincial government, the Chinese Communists likened the Chinese rule to that of Japan and expressed sympathy and support for the Formosan independence movement.

A shift occurred as the Chinese Nationalists began to take refuge on Formosa in 1949. At the end of 1949, the Communists listed the "liberation" of Formosa as one of the items of unfinished business in the Communist revolution to be completed in 1950. Only when the US interposed the Seventh Fleet in the Formosa Straits, following the outbreak of the Korean war, did the Communists advance their tenuous historical claims to Taiwan.

Office of the Special Assistant, Intelligence.

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